

A Descriptive and Informative Title: Subtitle If Needed

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Abstract

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1 Introduction

The modeling of a continuum media by a discrete bond network aiming to solve elastic problem dates back to the work of Hrennikoff in the early 1940s [9]. Although the finite element method eventually replaced bond networks to solve continuum solid mechanics problems, they gained back interest in the field of fracture thanks to their inherent ability to model discontinuities. The distinct element method was proposed to model granular media by [5] through the particle to particle interaction of spheres. The discrete and lattice methods were widely investigated and found to be suitable for the numerical simulation of fracture in brittle materials such as rocks, concrete and ceramics [19, 2, 11].

The simplest models consist of axial spring lattices. However, when particles in a lattice only interact through central forces, additional symmetry constraints are enforced by the Cauchy relations. For an isotropic material, the Poisson ratio is fixed to $\nu = \frac{1}{3}$ in 2D and to $\nu = \frac{1}{4}$ in 3D.

To overcome this limitation many scholars enriched this model. Starting with the widely used Born model [3] which introduces a non-central two-body interaction, typically an additional tangential spring. The addition of tangential springs may not preserve the rotational invariance and result in an incorrect strain energy [10]. Alternative approaches were formulated to address this limitation such as beam networks [19, 18, 4, 1] or the combination of axial and angular springs [15, 20]. The VCPM and LCM models govern the Poisson ratio through the stiffness of the cell surrounding the struts which resist volume change [16, 8]. The derivation of a 4 dimensional axial spring model showed the ability to control the Poisson ratio once projected back to 3 dimensions [22]. Although this method can seem un-natural it maintains the computational simplicity of the axial spring models.

The second problem arising concerns the choice of the bonds stiffness. The microscopic bond properties and the emerging macroscopic ones do not match. The strain energy equivalence between a network and its continuum equivalent is commonly employed to choose the microscopic properties. It has been investigated in 2D regular lattices [15] and extended to 3D for the 18 neighbors cubic lattice (bond directions [100] and [110]) and for the 14 neighbors cubic lattice (bond directions [100] and [111]) [13, 12]. This method has been applied to estimate the emerging Young's modulus of disordered lattices with uniform spring stiffness [12]. Conversely, it was locally applied to each cell of a 3D arbitrary mesh in order to derive the normal and angular spring stiffnesses required to obtain an isotropic behavior with a set Young's modulus and Poisson ratio [17].

Typical DEM networks use the same material parameters for all bonds which is simpler but means the isotropic behavior relies on the isotropy of the bond's orientations and can only be seen at the macroscopic scale [1]. On the other hand the energetic parametrisation gives an exact solution such that one unit cell is isotropic. For beam lattices, the choice of microscopic stiffnesses relies on a lengthy calibration process. The typical calibration process is a trial and error calibration that requires multiple tensile tests until matching the desired behavior [1]. To speed up this process analytical curves have been fitted to several pre-made numerical tensile tests [14]. An other approach is to take the bond's parameters as additional coordinates of the problem and solving it through a proper generalised decomposition [7].

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2 Energy equivalence method

Elate Software : [6]

- The goal is to match the strain energy of a RVE of the spring network to the strain energy of an equivalent continuous volume with the required behaviour.
- To deduce the final system we make the following assumptions :
 - Cauchy-Born rule : assumes that the displacements of the nodes follow the macroscopic strain and is linearised around each cell's center.
 - Major and minor symetries of the homogenised stiffness tensor.

As shown by [21] these conditions are met by central symmetric lattices but might not be for a general lattice.

- Final analytical expression of the homogenised stiffness tensor through energy equivalence :

$$C_{\alpha\beta\gamma\delta} = \sum_{ij} \frac{k_{ij} \|\underline{x}_{ij}\|^2}{V} n_{ij,\alpha} n_{ij,\beta} n_{ij,\gamma} n_{ij,\delta} \quad (1)$$

- showing the isotropic stiffness matrix we need to match :

$$C_{\alpha\beta\gamma\delta} = \lambda \delta_{\alpha\beta} \delta_{\gamma\delta} + \mu (\delta_{\alpha\gamma} \delta_{\beta\delta} + \delta_{\alpha\delta} \delta_{\beta\gamma}) \quad (2)$$

with the Lamé coefficients :

$$\lambda = \frac{E\nu}{(1+\nu)(1-2\nu)}, \quad \mu = \frac{E}{2(1+\nu)} \quad (3)$$

- show addition symmetry leading to nu = 0.25

$$\mathbb{C} = \sum_{ij} \underbrace{\frac{k_{ij} \|\underline{x}_{ij}\|^2}{V}}_{\equiv K_{ij}} \underbrace{\begin{pmatrix} n_1^4 & n_1^2 n_2^2 & n_1^2 n_3^2 & n_1^2 n_2 n_3 & n_1^3 n_3 & n_1^3 n_2 \\ n_1^2 n_2^2 & n_2^4 & n_2^2 n_3^2 & n_2^3 n_3 & n_1 n_2^2 n_3 & n_1 n_2^3 \\ n_1^2 n_3^2 & n_2^2 n_3^2 & n_3^4 & n_2 n_3^3 & n_1 n_3^3 & n_1 n_2 n_3^2 \\ n_1^2 n_2 n_3 & n_2^3 n_3 & n_2 n_3^3 & n_2^2 n_2^2 & n_1 n_2 n_2^2 & n_1 n_2^2 n_3 \\ n_1^3 n_3 & n_1 n_2^2 n_3 & n_1 n_3^3 & n_1 n_2 n_2^2 & n_1^2 n_2^2 & n_1^2 n_2 n_3 \\ n_1^3 n_2 & n_1 n_2^3 & n_1 n_2 n_3^2 & n_1 n_2^2 n_3 & n_1^2 n_2 n_3 & n_1^2 n_2^2 \end{pmatrix}}_{\mathbb{N}_{ij} \equiv [\underline{n}_{ij}^{\otimes 4}]_{\text{Voigt}}, \quad \text{notation : } n_{\alpha} \equiv n_{ij,\alpha}} \quad (4)$$

The fourth order tensor $\underline{n}_{ij}^{\otimes 4}$ has the same major and minor symmetries as $\mathbb{C}$ and an additional symmetry due to the commutativity of product. $\mathbb{N}_{ij,\alpha\alpha\beta\beta} = \mathbb{N}_{ij,\alpha\beta\alpha\beta}$ (an example of this additional symmetry is colored in the matrix above).

- This additional symetry + isotropy -> Cauchy relation (nu = 0.25)
This additional symmetry confirms the Cauchy relation in the case of an isotropic $\mathbb{C}$

$$\begin{pmatrix} \lambda + 2\mu & \lambda & \lambda & 0 & 0 & 0 \\ \lambda & \lambda + 2\mu & \lambda & 0 & 0 & 0 \\ \lambda & \lambda & \lambda + 2\mu & 0 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & \mu & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & 0 & \mu & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & 0 & 0 & \mu \end{pmatrix} = \sum_{ij} \frac{k_{ij} \|\underline{x}_{ij}\|^2}{V} \begin{pmatrix} n_1^4 & n_1^2 n_2^2 & n_1^2 n_3^2 & n_1^2 n_2 n_3 & n_1^3 n_3 & n_1^3 n_2 \\ n_1^2 n_2^2 & n_2^4 & n_2^2 n_3^2 & n_2^3 n_3 & n_1 n_2^2 n_3 & n_1 n_2^3 \\ n_1^2 n_3^2 & n_2^2 n_3^2 & n_3^4 & n_2 n_3^3 & n_1 n_3^3 & n_1 n_2 n_3^2 \\ n_1^2 n_2 n_3 & n_2^3 n_3 & n_2 n_3^3 & n_2^2 n_2^2 & n_1 n_2 n_2^2 & n_1 n_2^2 n_3 \\ n_1^3 n_3 & n_1 n_2^2 n_3 & n_1 n_3^3 & n_1 n_2 n_2^2 & n_1^2 n_2^2 & n_1^2 n_2 n_3 \\ n_1^3 n_2 & n_1 n_2^3 & n_1 n_2 n_3^2 & n_1 n_2^2 n_3 & n_1^2 n_2 n_3 & n_1^2 n_2^2 \end{pmatrix} \quad (5)$$

- Need a max of 15 different orientations to have a basis. [17] does this with additional angular springs -> 21 component to for a base and can adapt the poisson.

Show the symmetry in this equation that sets the poisson ratio to 0.25 (in 3D)

Monter qu'on peut mettre la longueur des bonds en évidence et uniquement travailler avec des orientations -> on résoud le meme systeme pour une cellule plus grande ou plus petite -> avec la proportion sur les longueurs et le volume représentatif.

3 Undeformed cubic periodic cells

- Face centered result
- Body centered result (that is by the way the smallest amount of bonds we can have in a cubic symmetric cell – demo in annex ??)

Give the analytical results for the BCC / FCC geometries and show that the numerical homogenisation confirms the analytical result

4 Deformed hex cell

1/ justify the number of bonds per cell in order to be able to solve the system Show examples of deformed cells

- parallelepiped
- "enlarged"
- sheared -> not working, not enough orientations

-> takes a lot of time to solve each cell independently Show analytical mapping is not possible and not even a function not possible analytically due to the degree of the equation and not even a function as we saw that the sheared cell was not solvable

5 Mesh of deformed hex -> need a faster parametrisation

5.1 keeping same parameters

Show that keeping the undeformed parameters doesn't allow to keep isotropy (deformed cells with a ratio 1 X 0.8 X 1.2) - and that we quickly get high anisotropy even for reasonable deformations

- Calibration of each cell independently 3/ show the results are not accurate when we add randomness because we are violating the linear displacement hypothesis -> show the high variation in stiffnesses.
- "Equivalent cell parametrisation"
 - Explain the idea of the method (how it reduces the variation in stiffness)
 - Show the influence of the number of sections. Less sections -> smaller linearity error but higher angle error.
 - Flexion test case : Regular meshing OK Change orientation KO Refinement KO -> Heterogeneity in the orientation repartition and in the density either work on more local parts of the mesh -> hard to automate)
 - Flexion test case with a one by one parametrisation

6 Tetrahedrons

because a tet cell cannot periodically pave the 3D space there is an automatic homogeneity in the repartition of bond throughout the mesh (there are no zones where a certain orientation is over - represented) when the cubic model introduces in homogeneities (which can be problematic for the equivalent cell representation but also influences possible crack paths -> reference articles that highlighted isotropy, homogeneity and boundary conformity as essential conditions)

7 Discussion

8 Conclusion

Summarise the key findings and their implications. Avoid introducing new material here. Optionally, state perspectives for future work.

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A Derivation of Equation

(1)

A.1 Writting the energy of the spring lattice

The strain energy stored in a unit cell of volume V is

$$W = \sum_{ij \in \text{bonds}} \frac{k_{ij}}{2} [(\underline{u}_j - \underline{u}_i) \cdot \underline{n}_{ij}]^2 = \sum_{ij} \frac{k_{ij}}{2 \|\underline{x}_{ij}\|^2} [(\underline{u}_j - \underline{u}_i) \cdot \underline{x}_{ij}]^2 \quad \text{with} \quad \underline{x}_{ij} = (\underline{x}_j - \underline{x}_i) \quad (6)$$

A.2 Taylor developement of the displacement

Substituing the displacement of a node by it's first order Taylor expansion around the center of the cell x_c :

$$(\underline{u}_j)_\alpha = (\underline{u}_c)_\alpha + (\underline{x}_j - \underline{x}_c) \cdot \nabla u_\alpha(\underline{x}_c) + \text{h.o.t.} \quad (7)$$

$$(\underline{u}_j - \underline{u}_i)_\alpha = (\underline{x}_j - \underline{x}_i) \cdot \nabla u_\alpha(\underline{x}_c) = \underline{x}_{ij} \cdot \nabla u_\alpha(\underline{x}_c) \quad (8)$$

Substituting into (6):

$$\begin{aligned} W &= \sum_{ij} \frac{k_{ij}}{2 \|\underline{x}_{ij}\|^2} (x_{ij,\beta} \nabla_\beta u_\alpha(x_c) x_{ij,\alpha}) (x_{ij,\delta} \nabla_\delta u_\gamma(x_c) x_{ij,\gamma}) \\ &= \sum_{ij} \frac{k_{ij}}{2 \|\underline{x}_{ij}\|^2} x_{ij,\alpha} x_{ij,\beta} x_{ij,\gamma} x_{ij,\delta} \nabla_\beta u_\alpha(x_c) \nabla_\delta u_\gamma(x_c) \end{aligned} \quad (9)$$

A.3 Identifying the strain tensor

$$\begin{aligned} x_{ij,\alpha} \nabla_\beta u_\alpha(\underline{x}_c) x_{ij,\beta} &= \frac{1}{2} (x_{ij,\alpha} \nabla_\beta u_\alpha(\underline{x}_c) x_{ij,\beta} + x_{ij,\beta} \nabla_\alpha u_\beta(\underline{x}_c) x_{ij,\alpha}) \\ &= \frac{1}{2} (\nabla_\beta u_\alpha(\underline{x}_c) + \nabla_\alpha u_\beta(\underline{x}_c)) x_{ij,\beta} x_{ij,\alpha} \end{aligned} \quad (10)$$

Assuming the nodes displacements follow the macroscopic strain (Cauchy-Born rule), the small deformations strain tensor can be written :

$$\varepsilon_{\alpha\beta}(x_c) = \frac{1}{2} (\nabla_\beta u_\alpha(x_c) + \nabla_\alpha u_\beta(x_c)) \quad (11)$$

Introducing (11) into (10)

$$x_{ij,\alpha} \nabla_\beta u_\alpha(x_c) x_{ij,\beta} = \varepsilon_{\alpha\beta}(x_c) x_{ij,\beta} x_{ij,\alpha} \quad (12)$$

And back into (9)

$$W = \sum_{ij} \frac{k_{ij}}{2 \|\underline{x}_{ij}\|^2} x_{ij,\alpha} x_{ij,\beta} x_{ij,\gamma} x_{ij,\delta} \varepsilon_{\alpha\beta} \varepsilon_{\gamma\delta} \quad (13)$$

A.4 Identification of the stiffness matrix

Th coninuous strain energy is :

$$W = \frac{1}{2} V C_{\alpha\beta\gamma\delta} \varepsilon_{\alpha\beta} \varepsilon_{\gamma\delta}, \quad (14)$$

Bu identification we obtain the homogenized stiffness tensor:

$$V C_{\alpha\beta\gamma\delta} = \sum_{ij} \frac{k_{ij}}{\|\underline{x}_{ij}\|^2} x_{ij,\alpha} x_{ij,\beta} x_{ij,\gamma} x_{ij,\delta} \quad (15)$$

$$C_{\alpha\beta\gamma\delta} = \sum_{ij} \frac{k_{ij} \|\underline{x}_{ij}\|^2}{V} n_{ij,\alpha} n_{ij,\beta} n_{ij,\gamma} n_{ij,\delta} \quad (16)$$

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